You

Currently, I'm studying an undergraduate Computer Science degree in England at the University of Bradford and going into my final year. After this I hope to land a graduate job but later I hope to pursue the pathway to become a professor/associate professor at my university. I know that I have to undertake at least one postgraduate course, however I'm unsure which ones and when I would have to do them. Giving me information specifically for England, what courses would I have to study next and what would be the UCAS application deadlines, course durations, etc. Also include information specific to the University of Bradford.

Copilot

Next Steps Toward an Academic Career in England

1. Taught Master's Degree (MSc/MRes)

- Purpose: deepen subject-specific and research skills ahead of a PhD.
- Duration: 1 year full-time (FT) or 2 years part-time (PT).
- Common Specialisms at Bradford:
  - Applied Computer Science and Artificial Intelligence MSc (FT, PT) bradford.ac.uk
  - Artificial Intelligence and Space Technology MSc (FT, PT) bradford.ac.uk
  - Cyber Security MSc (FT, PT) bradford.ac.uk
  - Satellite Systems Engineering MSc (FT, PT) bradford.ac.uk
- How to Apply: direct via Bradford's postgraduate portal.
- Typical Deadline: for October 2025 entry, aim to submit by end of August 2025.

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2. Research Degree (PhD/MPhil)

- Purpose: develop original research—essential for lecturer and professorial roles.
- Duration: 3–4 years FT or up to 6 years PT.
- Options at Bradford:
  - PhD in Computer Science (projects in AI, cybersecurity, networks, etc.).
  - MPhil by research.
- How to Apply: direct to Bradford's Research Degrees Office.
- Funding & Deadlines: many doctoral scholarships close in January each year, so early-year applications (January–March) are recommended.

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3. Higher Education Teaching Qualification (PGCert LTHE)

- Purpose: build pedagogical expertise, gain HEA accreditation for university teaching.
- Example Programme:
  - University of London – Postgraduate Certificate in Learning and Teaching in Higher Education
    • Mode: online, part-time
    • Duration: 1–5 years
    • Intakes: October 2025 & April 2026 london.ac.uk
- How to Apply: direct to the provider's portal; check each course's "Key dates" section (often 6–8 weeks before intake).

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4. Postgraduate Teacher Training (PGCE via UCAS)

- Purpose: obtain Qualified Teacher Status (QTS) for secondary or primary teaching.
- Routes (all via UCAS Teacher Training service) ucas.com:
  - PGCE (university-led)
  - School Direct (tuition-fee or salaried)
  - Postgraduate Teaching Apprenticeship
- Duration: typically 1 year FT.
- Application Deadlines:
  - Most courses advise applying by January for September start.
  - Final deadline for late applications is usually late June, but check individual provider.

Quick Comparison

Programme	Duration	Mode	Application Route	Typical Deadline	Main Intake
MSc in Applied CS & AI (Bradford)	1 yr FT, 2 yrs PT	On campus	Bradford direct	End Aug 2025	Oct 2025
PhD in Computer Science (Bradford)	3–4 yrs FT, 6 yrs PT	On campus	Bradford direct	Jan 2026 (funding)	Oct 2025 / Feb 2026
PGCert LTHE (Univ. of London)	1–5 yrs PT	Online	London direct	Early Sep 2025	Oct 2025, Apr 2026
PGCE (university-led)	1 yr FT	On campus	UCAS Teacher Train service ucas.com	Jan (equal cons.)	Sep 2025

Final Tips

- Taught and research postgraduate courses (MSc, MRes, PhD) are applied to directly via each university, not through UCAS undergraduate.
- Always consult Bradford's own course pages for up-to-date deadlines, entry requirements and fee-status details.
- For PhD funding, identify supervisors early and align your application with scholarship deadlines (often January).
- Completing a PGCert LTHE or HEA fellowship bolsters your teaching portfolio when applying for academic posts.
- If you need QTS for a stint in secondary teaching, UCAS Teacher Training is your one-stop portal.

Embarking on this sequence—master's, doctorate, plus a recognised HE teaching qualification—will position you strongly for a lectureship and, in time, an associate professorship at the University of Bradford.

References

(1) Computer Science - Subjects - University of Bradford
(2) PGCert Learning and Teaching in Higher Education | University of London
(3) Postgraduate Teacher Training in England

You

So if I started the MSc in October 2026, when would I be able to start teaching lectures in University and when would I become a fully qualified professor. Give me the full-time and part-time options. Bear in mind that my MSc will most likely be part time since I hope to have a graduate job but after that I might do my PhD full-time, consider part-time for that though as well

Copilot

Great thinking, Hasan — planning this pathway early gives you a serious edge. Let's break down your academic career timeline based on your plan to start a **part-time MSc in October 2026**, followed by either a **full-time or part-time PhD**, and ultimately aiming for a **lectureship and professorship** at a UK university like Bradford.

🎓 **Step-by-Step Academic Career Timeline (England)**

🧠 **1. MSc (Part-Time)**

- **Start**: October 2026
- **Duration**: 2 years (part-time)
- **End**: ~September 2028
- **Purpose**: Deepen subject knowledge and prepare for research.

🔬 **2. PhD (Full-Time or Part-Time)**

Mode	Start Date	Duration	Completion
Full-Time	Oct 2028	3–4 years	2031–2032
Part-Time	Oct 2028	5–6 years	2033–2034

- **Purpose**: Produce original research, publish papers, and build academic reputation.
- **Teaching During PhD**:

- You can start **lecturing part-time or assisting in modules** during your PhD (especially years 2–3).
- Many UK PhD students take on **Graduate Teaching Assistant (GTA)** roles or **Associate Lecturer** posts.

🏫 3. First Lectureship (Post-PhD or During Final PhD Year)

- **Earliest Start**:
  - If full-time PhD: ~2031
  - If part-time PhD: ~2033
- **Title**: Lecturer or Assistant Lecturer
- **Requirements**:
  - Completed PhD (or near completion)
  - Teaching experience (GTA, seminars, tutorials)
  - Often a **PGCert in Higher Education** or **HEA Fellowship** is expected or encouraged

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👨‍🏫 4. Promotion to Associate Professor / Senior Lecturer

- **Typical Timeline**: 3–6 years after first lectureship
- **Estimated Year**:
  - If full-time PhD: ~2034–2037
  - If part-time PhD: ~2036–2039
- **Requirements**:
  - Strong publication record
  - Successful PhD supervision
  - Leadership in curriculum development
  - External funding or research grants

👩‍🎓 5. Full Professorship

- **Typical Timeline**: 6–10+ years after first lectureship
- **Estimated Year**:
  - If full-time PhD: ~2037–2042
  - If part-time PhD: ~2039–2044
- **Requirements**:
  - International research reputation
  - Major contributions to your field
  - Extensive teaching and supervision
  - Leadership roles (e.g. Head of Department, Research Director)

📂 Summary Timeline

Stage	Full-Time PhD Path	Part-Time PhD Path
MSc (PT)	2026–2028	2026–2028
PhD	2028–2031/32	2028–2033/34
First Lectureship	~2031	~2033
Associate Professor	~2034–2037	~2036–2039
Full Professor	~2037–2042	~2039–2044

🧭 Final Advice

- **Start teaching early**: You don't need to wait until you finish your PhD to start lecturing. Many universities hire PhD candidates as part-time lecturers or GTAs.
- **Balance work and study**: Your plan to do the MSc part-time while working is smart. It builds both academic and industry credibility.
- **Build your teaching portfolio**: Consider doing a PGCert in Higher Education during your PhD or early lectureship years.
- **Network at Bradford**: Stay in touch with faculty, attend research seminars, and express your long-term interest in academia—they'll remember your commitment.

Would you like help mapping out a CV or academic portfolio that aligns with this timeline?

Conversation by Fifa Utuber with Copilot on Thursday, Aug 7 2025